



The Killer Edge

METAL GEAR RISING REVENGEANCE

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Developed by Platinum Games (of Bayonetta and Vanquish fame) and helmed by Kojima Productions, Metal Gear Rising: Revengeance is a nuanced hack-and-slash game with emphasis on melee-combat (no guns here). Revengeance is quite unlike other games in the genre, such as God of War, Darksiders and Devil May Cry, with several different gameplay mechanics, the most famous of which is the Blade mode, also giving the game its tag line – cut at will.

Revengeance's Blade mode builds on a concept that has been a wet dream for every hack-and-slash gamer – near complete three-dimensional control of a weapon, in this case, Raiden's high-frequency katana blade. The Blade mode mechanism is governed by two analogue controls, one for the blade, and the other for the camera – which implies no movement while in Blade mode. It's also one of the most difficult things to master in the game, with experimentation required to choose a suitably intuitive control layout from the presets. Another major difference from other hack-and-slash games is the lack of a distinct evade or block move.

Instead, Revengeance solely utilizes a parry move to deflect attacks. While other

games have used the parry concept, the move is usually accompanied by evade. Here the only alternative, Ninja Run, takes time to start up, and jumping isn't effective for several reasons. This means you'll have to break your combos to parry in time. As you can imagine, this punishes button mashing with a vengeance. A correctly timed parry can trigger a quick time event, of which there are two types – button based, or Zandatsu which is Blade-mode based.

Put simply, the learning curve of MGR: Revengeance becomes quite steep quite early in the game, but once you pass that hump the game will become much more satisfying and rewarding. Interesting DLC packs have already been released with new playable characters, further increasing replay value.

The game is meant to be played several times over to truly max out Raiden's abilities and get special weapons and suits. Apart from combat, the game's graphics and game design are top-notch, with enemy attacks, weapon arcs and special moves featuring edgy VFX. The environments are also well detailed, and realistic character modelling is evident.

MGR: Revengeance's storyline dwells on terrorism, exploitation, and moral high grounds, but instead of being too pretentious, manages to deliver a tongue-in-cheek self-deprecating flavour. Raiden's treat-

ment at the hands of several bosses also has to be seen to be believed – shocking moments that will last you a lifetime.*

Verdict

Metal Gear Rising: Revengeance is a challenging hack-and-slash that rewards gamers with glorious, razor-sharp action that satisfies the killer within them. Coupled with a bizarre but entertaining storyline, and its multiple-playthrough nature, Revengeance becomes a must-play for all hack-and-slash fans. Series regulars willing to forego cherished stealth and tactics for a great time set in a familiar universe, should also give it a try.

MOAR!

- » **Developer:** Platinum Games, Kojima Productions
- » **Publisher:** Konami
- » **Platform:** Xbox 360, PS3
- » **Price:** ₹3,499

